

L007: Code Review English: Giving & Receiving Feedback

Free Practice Sheet | @ondutyenglish | oabuilds.io/practice/L007

Lane E — Tech & Programmer English

Section 1 — Key Vocabulary

1. refactor

/ˌrɪːˈfæktər/ verb

To restructure existing code without changing its external behaviour.

"I'd suggest we refactor this function — it's getting too complex."

Tagalog: baguhin ang istraktura ng code nang hindi binabago ang resulta

2. edge case

/ɛdʒ keɪs/ noun

An unusual or extreme scenario that a program must handle correctly.

"What happens in the edge case where the user submits an empty form?"

Tagalog: espesyal na sitwasyon na bihirang mangyari

3. nit

/nɪt/ noun (informal)

A minor, low-priority comment in a code review (short for 'nitpick').

"Nit: consider renaming this variable to something more descriptive."

Tagalog: maliit na komento sa code review

4. lgtm

/ˌɛl dʒiː tiː ˈɛm/ abbreviation

'Looks Good To Me' — approval signal in a code review.

"LGTM — nice clean implementation. Merging now."

Tagalog: pahintulot sa code review

On Duty English

5. blocking comment

/ˈblɒkɪŋ ˈkɒment/ noun phrase

A review comment that must be addressed before the PR can be merged.

"This is a blocking comment — the SQL query is vulnerable to injection."

Tagalog: komento na kailangang ayusin bago i-merge

6. regression

/rɪˈɡrɛʃən/ noun

A bug introduced by a new change that breaks previously working functionality.

"The new login flow caused a regression in the password reset feature."

Tagalog: bagong bug na dulot ng pagbabago sa code

7. coverage

/ˈkʌvərɪdʒ/ noun

The percentage of code tested by automated tests.

"Test coverage for this module is only 45% — we need more unit tests."

Tagalog: saklaw ng mga test sa code

8. approve

/əˈpruːv/ verb

To formally accept a pull request after review.

"I'm happy to approve this once the blocking comment is addressed."

Tagalog: aprubahan ang code

Section 2 — Phrases & Patterns

Could you clarify the intent behind...?

Ask for explanation without criticising.

"Could you clarify the intent behind this conditional? I want to make sure I'm not missing context."

This might be worth refactoring because...

Suggest improvement constructively.

"This might be worth refactoring because it's duplicating logic from the auth module."

Nit: consider...

Flag a minor, non-blocking suggestion.

"Nit: consider extracting this into a helper function for readability."

On Duty English

This is a blocking comment — ...

Flag a required change clearly.

"This is a blocking comment — the API key is hardcoded and must be moved to environment variables."

Section 3 — Scenario Practice

Read the dialogue aloud. Circle any words you found difficult to pronounce.

Reviewer: Hey, I've left a few comments on your PR. Nothing major — mostly nits, but there's one blocking comment.

Developer: Thanks. What's the blocking one?

Reviewer: The API key is hardcoded on line 47. That's a security issue — it needs to go into environment variables before we can merge.

Developer: Good catch. I'll fix that now. What about the nits?

Reviewer: Just style things — could you clarify the intent behind the conditional on line 83? And there's a potential edge case if the user object is null.

Developer: Understood. I'll add a null check and add a comment explaining the logic. Should improve coverage too.

Reviewer: Perfect. Once those are addressed, LGTM. Nice clean PR overall.

Section 4 — Self-Evaluation

After completing the exercises, tick each item you feel confident about:

I can give a code review comment that is constructive, not critical.

I can distinguish between a blocking comment and a nit.

I can use 'refactor', 'regression', 'edge case', and 'coverage' in context.

I can respond to review feedback professionally in English.

Section 5 — My Notes

On Duty English

Lessons developed using AI-assisted production with reviewed industry vocabulary sources. © On Duty English | @ondutyenglish | oabuilds.io